



**MFC**  
YOUTH

# CHAPTER SERVANTS TRAINING *manual*

### **Rationale**

Chapter Servants have an important role in MFC Youth. They are partners of the ministry in its life and mission. It is important for them to understand all the aspects of community life. They are the ones who set the direction of their areas according to the vision and mission of MFC Youth. They are pastors who take care of their flock – the Household Servants. They also need to develop the skills necessary for them to run their chapter amidst their day-to-day life and conflicts. The CST Manual serves as an important training for them to be equipped in their service as Chapter Servants.

### **Target Audience:**

- MFC Youth Chapter Servants

### **Specific Objectives**

At the end of the session, the participants will be able to:

1. Be equipped in their service as Chapter Servants
2. Perform their tasks and embrace their calling as Chapter Servants

### **Methodology:**

The CST Manual consists of workshops that will equip the Chapter Servants the necessary skills needed in their service. This manual consists of the following:

- Roles and Responsibilities
- Evangelistic Sensitivity
- Love Forum
- LBS Training
- Building, Inspiring and Forming a Killer Team
- Visionary Leadership
- Strategic Planning
- Together To Get There
- Leading a Youth Assembly
- Relating with Couple Coordinator

## Talk Writing Workshop

### Objectives

At the end of the workshop, participant should be able to:

1. Know the importance of writing a pastoral talk.
2. Learn and enhance their skill of writing a pastoral talk.
3. Create a pastoral talk.

### Methodology

|               |                 |
|---------------|-----------------|
| 00:00 – 00:45 | Workshop Proper |
| 00:45 – 01:30 | Activity        |

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction: The Urgency to Preach

*“If I preach the gospel, this is no reason for me to boast, for an obligation has been imposed on me, and woe to me if I do not preach it!”*

*(1 Corinthians 9:16)*

St. Paul wrote these words in a time where hopelessness envelope the world; in a place where people are restless and unhappy; to a world who does not knew Christ and yet St. Paul utter these words for a reason!

St. Paul uses these words to remind the early Christians that it is with utmost importance for them to declare that there is HOPE; He uses these words to inspire them to proclaim the good news to a generation; He uses it to stress what a privileged it is to be used as the mouth piece of the Lord.

I believe that what is urgent in St. Paul then remain urgent for us today! What is there duty before remains to be an active call for us! The Call to Proclaim the Gospel of Jesus Christ!



## II. Instrument of Grace

In all the service we had, all of us would agree that the closest thing we have experience in preaching is giving a CLS or Youth Camp talk. All of us here knew how God had used us as we gave different kind of talks to different kind of people! Even our own renewal started when we started listening to these talks. Hence, we can say that these talks have become God's instrument of grace for all of us!

Two questions we might be asking ourselves right now; why write? And why me? It can be done by other people. So why do we need to learn this skill?

### a. Why Write

Truly our life was never the same when we have heard the greatest truth of them all that God loves us! This realization has brought great joy in our lives! Yet we could never have that kind of joy if this message revealed to the disciples before us was never passed on to us. And it could never be passed on to us unless someone had put it into writing. And so, we too write in order to pass on God's messages to a whole new generation of believers.

*"And we write this that you may have perfect joy."*

*(1 John 1:4)*

### b. Why Me

Yes, God has chosen us to be the writers of His wonderful love! Despite all our weaknesses and sinfulness, God has called us to write. He wants you to write because you have experience first-hand how His mercy and love overflows! He chooses you so that might have the privilege bearing fruits for Him!

*"It was not you who chose me, but I who chose you and appointed you to go and bear fruit that will remain, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name he may give you."*

*(John 15:16)*

## III. The Right Perspective

Now that we knew why we need to write and why did He choose us to write. We now must have the right posture in doing this wonderful mission that the Lord has entrusted to us

## **The Heart of a Writer**

A good talk is only as good as the heart of its writer for the Lord says from the fullness of the heart the mouth speaks! And so, what is inside our hearts reflects what we write. Therefore, our heart should be:

- a. Prayerful – We need to be connected to the True Source. We need to constantly talk to the Lord. He, who gives us knowledge and wisdom.
- b. Patient – We need to learn how to wait for God's messages. Inspirations do not come in just a snap. We need to have a patient heart in waiting for His wisdom to reach our hearts.
- c. Humble – We need to learn how to accept comments and correction. Be willing to be criticized by other people. It's a pruning process that we need to undergo for us to write something that is so good.

## **IV. The Writing Process**

A good talk is a talk that goes through the right process. In Missionary Families of Christ, here is how we write talks:

### **i. Step One: Preparation**

- Pray - Ask for the grace to hear and receive God's message
- Brainstorm for Talking Points – Discuss your reflections
- Read bible, books, reference materials – Research, Deepened

### **ii. Second Step: Talk Writing**

- Determine the Rationale of the Talk – This should make the talk in sync in the overall flow of activities / sessions. It answers why are you writing the talk
- Describe the Talk – This will give your speaker a general overview of what the talk is all about
- Know your Participants – You should consider first to whom are you giving this talk for (age, interest, groups). This will help you write examples in your talk
- Know the General and Specific Objectives of the Talk - Our writing should be aligned to these and not contradicting it. Your talk's objective should compose of Head, Heart and Hand goals.
- Discussed your Methodology – Explain how the talk should be executed.
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- Write your Expanded Outline – This contains God's message that you would like to share. It should have the following parts
- Create talk skeleton – What we usually use in MFC Youth is the GMGM Model. This stands for God's Love, Man's Problem, God's Solution and Man's Response

### **iii. Third Step: Revision**

- Submit your talk outline to your leader for approval – Let them comment about what you have written.
- Revision – Get ready to revise your work 3 times.
- Get Feedback – Get feedback between writers perspective and speakers perspective.

## **V. Final Tips**

- There are normally 3 basic tenets to follow in writing talks, hence all talks should have:
  - a. Scriptural basis (Doctrine)
  - b. Attitudinal change (Moral)
  - c. Living-out mechanism (Worship)
- This is a basic catechetical strategy known in some circles as "doctrine, moral, and worship"
- Make it Simple. Do not use jargon, use generic examples, and use simple words
- Watch out for content overload. People retain only 7% (scientific findings) of what is said in a talk. Putting in more details will just be overshadowed by new information.
- Our talk goal is character change. A writer must engage his audience into a thinking process. If the talk is situated in a conference or a retreat, the design should be such that there measurable indicators of success, or if not, a follow-up of topics should ensue so that what has been said is reinforced and practiced. Otherwise, you have a useless venture

## **VI. Activity**

Allow the participants to draft their pastoral talk for 15 minutes and after that, they have 15 minutes to present their work.

## Evangelistic Sensitivity Workshop

### Objectives

At the end of the workshop, participant should be able to:

1. Know the importance of evangelization
2. Realize the urgency of sharing the Good News of Salvation through their life stories and Gospel

### Methodology

00:00-00:45 Workshop Proper

00:45-01:30 Activity

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction

*‘Then Jesus approached and said to them, “All power in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Go, therefore, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you. And behold, I am with you always, until the end of the age.”’*

*Matthew 28:18-20*

This is the Great Commissioning of the Disciples in Galilee before He ascended to Heaven. His last words were to “Go and make disciples of all nations.” It is therefore not an option, but a command that we should follow. We are to teach them to observe all of Christ’s teachings. We should be ready to share the Gospel anytime for mission is wherever we are.

#### II. Basics of Evangelization

What is evangelization? Evangelization came from the Greek word euangelion which means “good news.” It is the zealous proclamation of the Gospel to bring others to Christ and his Church (catholicculture.org).

According to the Catechism of the Catholic Church #425, “the transmission of the Christian faith consists primarily in proclaiming Jesus Christ in order to lead others to faith in him. From the

beginning, the first disciples burned with the desire to proclaim Christ: "We cannot but speak of what we have seen and heard (Acts 4:20)."



When we evangelize, it is Jesus Christ that we proclaim so that others may also believe. This is what the first disciples did because they saw Jesus with their own eyes and heard His teachings with their own ears.

Even if we do not see Jesus in our time, we can attest that He is real. Our lives have been changed forever, the moment we started a personal relationship with Him. He transformed us from who we were before to who we are now. He has performed great wonders in our lives and had fulfilled His promises again and again. He stayed with us and has become our strength in times of challenges and trials.

All these make up the "Jesus story" of every Christian. This story is what we should be ready to share with other people, whenever, wherever.

### **III. The Proper Mindset**

Now that we know the importance of evangelization, let us look into the proper mindset that we should have when we evangelize:

- a. You can't give what you don't have.

You should be evangelized first before you can even evangelize others. You should be so convicted that "there is no salvation through anyone else, nor is there any other name under heaven given to the human race by which we are to saved [than Jesus Christ] (Acts 4:12)."

It is said, "for from the fullness of the heart the mouth speaks (Lk 6:45)." Is your heart full of Christ that you can speak of Him anytime?

- b. You need a real encounter with Jesus.

No matter how great or eloquent a speaker you are, if you don't know WHO you're talking about and how this Person changed you for the better, evangelization shall not take place. A real encounter with Jesus is not something that you can invent or fake, because knowing Him affects you so much to live like Him and follow Him.





c. If God wants you to say something, then it needs to be heard.

Don't say "My story is not cool enough or impressive enough." Every person has a unique story to tell. God wants you to share your "Jesus Story" in season or out of season (2 Tim 4:12). You should always be ready to give an explanation to anyone who asks you for a reason for your hope (1 Peter 3:15).

#### **IV. Evangelistic Sensitivity**

Evangelistic sensitivity is having the openness to the leading of the Holy Spirit with regard to the person He wants you to share Jesus with. Here are some examples of evangelistic sensitivity:

- In Acts 8:26-39, we will read how Philip evangelized an Ethiopian Eunuch. Philip was so open to the leading of the Spirit that when He said to him, "Go and join up with that chariot," he ran and did what He was told to do. To cut the long story short, Philip helped the Ethiopian Eunuch understand the passages from the prophet Isaiah by proclaiming Jesus. The Ethiopian Eunuch was baptized right there and then!
- A similar incident happened to a man which Jeff Cavins shared in one of his bible studies. In a gas station, a man named Jeff heard God tell him "Tell this man 'God loves you.'" He tried to ignore it, but the word was persistent. So he tells the man "Um, Sir? I just wanted to tell you that Jesus loves you" The man slammed his hand on the counter and said "What is it with you guys? You're the third person to say that to me today!!" Clearly, God is talking to this random man. He wants to use us to make the Gospel known to the world, but we need to always be open to the leading of the Spirit."

#### **V. The Gospel Message**

Before we develop our evangelistic sensitivity, it is important to know the Gospel message that we will share to other people. For this workshop, we have two kinds of Gospel – the objective Gospel and the subjective Gospel.

##### **i. The Objective Gospel**

The Objective Gospel follows the G-M-G-M Model. This is God's love, Man's problem, God's solution and Man's response.

#### a. God's Love

This is God's original plan for man. God, in a plan of sheer goodness freely created man to make him share in his own blessed life. At every time and in every place, God draws close to man. (CCC 1)

#### b. Man's Problem

Man sinned and so we can never be with Him. Sin and God cannot mix. "All have sinned and are deprived of the glory of God (Rom 3:23)."

#### c. God's Solution

He sent His only begotten Son who suffered, died and rose again. "Everyone who believes in Him might not perish but might have eternal life (Jn 3:16)." We can be made one with God again, particularly through the Sacraments.

#### d. Man's Response

Man needs to receive the gift of salvation by accepting and believing in the Gospel as truth and by living in the truth that is Christ. "Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved (Mk 16:16)." "For, if you confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved (Rom 10:9)."

### ii. Subjective Gospel

The Subjective Gospel is no other than our personal testimony following the G-M-G-M format. Most of the time, we'll be able to share the subjective gospel than the objective Gospel. This is the story of how we personally experienced God's love, how our sin has kept us away from Him, how we are saved by the Son, and how we responded. Here's how to prepare your Subjective Gospel:

#### a. Pray.

Reflect on how God has brought you to Him. Think of one major specific thing/area in your life where God encountered you and changed you. (e.g. relationship with family, studies, friends, etc.)

#### b. Write it down.

Evenly spread out your story into 3 parts – before, turning point, after.

(Note: If you are to give a 3-minute testimony, each part will be given 1 minute. This is to avoid focusing too much on one part (e.g. issues, sinful past, etc.).

- Before: How were you before you encountered God? (the not-so-good stuff, vices, sinful past)
- Turning Point: How did you encounter God? (these are events that led to your change of mind and heart and repentance like a worship, retreat, Holy Mass, Adoration,

a striking talk, etc.)

- After: What are the changes in yourself or your life ever since you encountered God? (the effects of your personal relationship with God like better communication lines with your parents, turning away from vices, excelling in your studies, etc.)

## **VI. Conclusion**

*“But how can they call on him in whom they have not believed? And how can they believe in him of whom they have not heard? And how can they hear without someone to preach? And how can people preach unless they are sent? As it is written, “How beautiful are the feet of those who bring [the] good news!”*

*(Romans 10:14-15)*

St. Paul, one of the most influential evangelizers in our Church History once said the lines above. Indeed, evangelization starts with being open to be sent. Once sent, we should be ready to preach the Gospel. Only then can it be heard by people. Only then can they believe and call on the Lord. Now is the time to share the Good News of our Salvation. Let us desire, wait and watch for opportunities to share God’s love. Just like the saints, martyrs and missionaries before us, let us be sensitive to the promptings of the Holy Spirit.

## **VII. Activity: Emmaus Walk**

1. Instruct the participants to prepare their Jesus story.
2. Tell them to divide a piece of paper into 3 columns for the 3 parts – before, turning point, after.
3. Have them pair up (by buddies if possible) to do the “Emmaus Walk” where they will go to a public place and apply evangelistic sensitivity to random people by sharing their Jesus Story to them.
4. They should assign who among the two of them is Person A and Person B.
5. While Person A is doing an “Emmaus Walk” with a random person he/she sensed to be needing God’s Word, Person B should be looking after Person A from a distance and praying for him/her silently.
6. Person B should repeat Step #4 once Person A is done with his/her “Emmaus Walk.”
7. Gather the participants back in one circle for sharing, questions, comments, processing and closing empowerment messages.

# MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

## Core Circle

### Chapter Servants Training Manual



#### Love Forum

#### Objectives

1. Realize that true love should be life-giving and should make them better persons; and
2. Know how to seek God's will in this very sensitive area of their lives

#### Methodology

|               |                             |
|---------------|-----------------------------|
| 00:00 – 00:05 | Singing of love songs       |
| 00:05 – 00:50 | Session Proper with Sharers |
| 00:50 – 01:00 | Prayer                      |
| 01:00 – 01:30 | Discussion group            |

#### Expanded Outline

##### I. Introduction

Falling in love is normal. It is a part of life. As human beings we are bound to experience falling in love simply because we are created by God who is Love. We are created by Love and we are created out of love.

For if man exists it is because God has created him through love, and through love continues to hold him in existence. He cannot live fully according to truth unless he freely acknowledges that love and entrusts himself to his creator. [Catechism of the Catholic Church (CCC) 27]

It is in our nature to want to love and to be loved. We long to be loved, that is why we want to belong to a group when we were younger. Because deep inside you, you want to share that love that you are made of.

*Note to the speaker: You don't need to read to the audience CCC 27; you can include that in your powerpoint though. But it has to be mentioned because that is the proof of our claim that we are made out of love. The main point of this part is to tell the participants that falling in love is normal.*



## II. The Power of Love

Falling in love is one of the most exciting and overwhelming experiences in a person's life. True love has the power to transform us into a loving and lovable person. It can bring out the best in us and move us to do great and wonderful things. It can lead us to a lifetime of happiness if we realize early enough that love is a gift from God, who is the source and object of love.

*Note to the speaker: At this point the speaker can share some examples of what people think, do, or say when in love. This is a chance to connect to the participants because everybody can relate to it.*

However, the world presents to us a distorted kind of romantic love. Media paints love and falling in love with images that are only half true. The following are some wrong notions about love:

*We see this all over the movies, the television shows that we watch and magazines that we read.*

1. Love is a fairy tale, and so, it is living happily ever after.
  - a. Many people get carried away because they are swooned by the first prince charming or pretty princes they meet.
2. Love can live on romance alone, thus, the "I can live on love alone" attitude."
3. I can do what I want as long as I am in love.

*Note to the speaker: You can give examples in each point.*

For those who do not know what true love is, love can also be ugly and tragic. What starts out as a beautiful relationship can end up hating and hurting each other for lovers. Good people, smart people, beautiful people are not spared from the danger of love. They can get genuinely hurt and can be scarred for life if they do not know how to love truly.

This early, we should understand the true essence of romantic love. This is important so that we can be spared from all the heartaches and pains, and truly fulfill and experience God's promise of love for us.

## III. What is True Love?

In a world with so many twisted definitions about love it is important to understand the real meaning of true love. According to Pope John Paul II's Theology of the Body, "Love is a decision

driven by commitment". For love is not merely a feeling; it is an act of will that consists of preferring, in a constant manner, the good of others to the good of oneself." Since Love is defined as always seeking the greatest possible good of the beloved. And we know and acknowledge that there is nothing that can be greater than God, then we are led to always desiring God for our beloved. We desire heaven for them. True love therefore is self-giving!



Entering in an exclusive relationship is actually hard work. It is not just some game that you can just quit if times are getting tougher. It does not only involve only yourself, but it includes the feelings and the whole being of another person. Let us therefore breakdown what true love is:

**1. Love is a commitment.**

When the romance dies, you still choose to love each other. Romance is just the icing on the cake. Your commitment to love each other no matter what, is what will sustain the relationship and never romance alone.

When you say "I love you," it means you will love the person through the worst of times. If you are not ready to love someone this much, then don't go into that relationship because it would definitely not last.

**2. Love is so precious.**

It is choosing the welfare of your partner first before yours. (This contradicts what most people do or say: "If you love me, you will have sex with me." This attitude thinks of one's self first, not the other persons.)

If you see the one that you love as precious, you will court the person in her house. You will have the courage to face their parents and tell them your intentions to their daughter. Courtship is the time for the man to prove his love for the woman. If he cannot even go to her house and go through all the trouble, then what kind of love is that? Right at the start, it is obvious that the man cares more for himself and his comfort than the woman.

**3. Love is worth waiting for.**

Having crushes and being attracted to the opposite sex are normal. However, you should pray and think hard before you get into a relationship. Love is an unconditional commitment that a person in his/her early teens may be unprepared to make. For love to be right and life-giving, one needs to be prepared for its long-term consequences. Do not rush into it. The goal of entering an exclusive relationship is to get married. If marriage is far from your priorities right now, then maybe entering a relationship should not cross your mind yet. Delayed gratification.

This would eliminate the pain and the scar of changing boyfriend/girlfriend often. One indicator that you are not yet ready for a relationship is when your parents say no to it. Remember that parents want the best for you, and they know you too well. If you force it and go to an underground relationship, your relationship becomes ugly. Love should be celebrated. If you are hiding it even to the people closest to you, then it must not be love.

If you truly love the person, you will also wait for the right time to have sex. The right time to have sex is inside marriage. Sex is a gift from God to procreate. Our relationship becomes even more complicated when we have premarital sex. What premarital sex does to us is taken away the true meaning of true love which is self-sacrifice, thinking of the other first.

Premarital sex teaches us to just think of ourselves first. Premarital sex brings with it the burden of guilt. Do not rush into sex. This is a beautiful gift from God we can enjoy only under the sanctity of marriage. By then, you can do it every day if you like, even five (5) times a day.

*Note to speaker: If you are not married yet, do not mention the last sentence because you are not yet credible.*

#### IV. Preparing for your one true love

How do you prepare? First things first, know your vocation! God is calling us to respond to an invitation whether for married life, religious life, or single blessedness. We should exercise our freedom by exploring these options and eventually finding our one true vocation. Everyone should not have a road not taken but options considered for this frees us to love according to God's will.

If you already know that you are for married life, follow these three easy steps:

##### 1. A – Adore God first.

Fall in love with God first. He is the source of all love. Remember that you cannot give what you don't have. If your heart is not filled with love, what kind of love can you give to the other person? Love also the very people God has given you.



If you cannot love your parents and siblings first you have no right to love another person which actually you are not related to.

*Note to the speaker: Share the glass, water, and pitcher analogy.*



## **2. B – Be the best person you can be.**

The best way to prepare yourself is to be the best person now. Be the best that you can be in all important areas of your life:

- a. Be beautiful inside and outside. If you want other people to like you, dress nicely. For women, dress modestly. Remember you need not show skin to be liked. You must be desired for who you are not what you look like. You do not need signature clothes to look good.
- b. If you are still studying, concentrate on that first. Make it your top priority. Be the best student. If you are working be the best worker and coworker. Excel in your field.
- c. Widen your circle of friends to broaden your field of choice.
- d. As a Christian, be a good witness in the way you live your life and in your service.

## **3. C – Create a Standard**

If you don't have a standard, you will end up just falling for anyone. Remember that you deserve the best. Physical attraction is important, but it is not the sole basis for a lasting relationship. Choose the right person for the right reasons. Look for qualities that last in the person whom you will choose. After making that standard, offer it up for the Lord. Trust that there is always someone that the Lord has prepared for you.  
*Note to the speaker: If you are still single, this is the best time to share your conviction in waiting. If you are in a relationship, share as well your process of waiting and how you value your relationship now.*

## **4. C – Consecrate your relationship to God.**

A relationship that is right with God from the beginning can be beautiful and life-giving. The body is not a pleasure machine. It is the temple of the Holy Spirit. We need to cloak ourselves in dignity and honor as sons and daughters of God. If we truly love a person, we lead him/ her to God and not cause him/ her to sin.

*Note to the speaker: You can add this part if you're talking to a crowd where there are people who are in a relationship.*





## V. Conclusion

Love is good. Love is beautiful. Let us learn to love deeply, honestly, and sincerely because love is from God who is the source of pure and true love. May we never do anything that will cheapen the true purposes God has for love.

But Love can also be tragic if it is not right. It can destroy you, and it can destroy the people whom you love and those who love you. This early, be wise to choose the genuine ways of love as a way of preventing yourself from making serious mistakes.

God loves us and he has a plan for us, and part of this beautiful plan is for us to have the best love life we can ever have. If we will only surrender the pen of our love story to God, rest assured, we have a future worth waiting for.

## **Liturgical Bible Study Facilitators Training**

### **Rationale**

In 2008, the Liturgical Bible Study was introduced to the community. It received positive feedback in terms of its nourishing and transformative value and easy-to adopt both in terms of methodology and context such as household meetings, family, and workplace. Furthermore, the anointing on the methodology is slowly being manifested and understood with affirmations from timing as it came with the Synod of the Bishop in the Word of God and the pastoral directions from the Bishops. The LBS is also now becoming to be a major alternative entry point and service to the parishes as side from Family and Life.

### **Objectives**

At the end whole-day training-workshop, the participants will be able to:

1. Be familiar with the content of the Bible.
2. Discuss the methods of interpretation of the Bible and the basic methodology and steps used in the conduct the Liturgical Bible Study.
3. Facilitate the Liturgical Bible Study.

### **Methodology**

|               |                                       |
|---------------|---------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15 | Arrival/ Registration                 |
| 09:15 – 09:30 | Teaching of Songs                     |
| 09:30 – 10:00 | Morning Worship                       |
| 10:00 – 10:15 | Orientation                           |
| 10:15 – 11:00 | Session 1                             |
| 11:00 – 12:00 | Session 2                             |
| 12:00 – 01:00 | LUNCH                                 |
| 01:00 – 01:15 | Gathering Song                        |
| 01:15 – 01:30 | Afternoon Worship                     |
| 01:30 – 02:45 | Workshop 1 (w/ processing) - optional |
| 02:45 – 03:00 | BREAK                                 |
| 03:00 – 04:15 | Workshop 2 (w/ processing)            |
| 04:15 – 05:00 | Session 3                             |
| 05:00 – 05:30 | Closing Worship                       |

## Session 1: The Bible and Its Content

### Bible Familiarization

- I. What is a Bible?
  - i. Collection of inspired writings.
  - ii. Names: Bible, Sacred Scriptures, Sacred or Holy Book, the Word of God, the Old & New Testaments
  - iii. Originates – *“biblia” – Latin or Greek meaning the books*
  - iv. A Library or a collection of books – the literature of the chosen people
- II. What is a Canon?
  - i. It means “list.”
  - ii. It is also the Greek for “rule” or “norm.” It forms the “rule” or “norm” of the faith.
  - iii. They are recognized and accepted as inspired by God.
  - iv. CANON is a list of books that the Church recognizes to be inspired by God and necessary for our faith.

### III. Activity

Materials Needed:

1. Notebook or Paper
2. Pen or Pencil

#### Part 1

Instruction: For 5 minutes, leaf thru the pages of your Bible and look for answers of the following.

1. Number of Books: Old Testament, New Testament & Entire Bible
2. How many chapters do you have in Baruch, Ester & Daniel?
3. In Daniel 3, how many verses do you have?
4. What is the version of the Bible used by the group?

Answer Key:

|            | <u>OT</u> | <u>NT</u> |   | <u>Total</u> |
|------------|-----------|-----------|---|--------------|
| Catholics  | 46        | 27        | = | 83           |
| Protestant | 39        | 27        | = | 66           |
| Ecumenical | 51        | 27        | = | 78           |

Differences:

- 7 books – Catholic to Protestant
- 12 writings – Protestant to Ecumenical

Seven Books not in the Protestant Canon

1. Tobit
2. Judith
3. Sirach
4. Wisdom of Solomon
5. Baruch
6. 1 Maccabees
7. 2 Maccabees

Five additional writings not in the Ecumenical Canon

1. Esther (Greek)
2. Letter of Jeremiah
3. Songs of the 3 Young Men
4. Susanna
5. Bel and the Dragon

Part 2

Questions:

1. What differences have you found with the books of Baruch, Daniel and Ester? How have you resolved the discrepancies?
2. What have you discovered in Daniel 3? How do you account for this?

Answers:

| <u>Book</u>       | <u>Catholic</u> | <u>Protestant</u> |
|-------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| Baruch (Chapter)  | 06              | 05                |
| Daniel (Chapter)  | 14              | 12                |
| Daniel 3 (Verses) | 100             | 30                |
| Esther (Greek)    | Included        | Deleted           |

### Explanation of the Differences

- Council of Jamnia (90 – 95 AD)
  - Towards the end of the 1<sup>st</sup> century: Jewish rabbis met in Jamnia, town west of Jerusalem
  - Criteria to determine the sacred character of books:
    - Conformity with the Pentateuch (first 5 books)
    - Written in Hebrew
    - Written in Palestine - Israel
    - Written before 400 B.C
  - Accepted 39 Books
  
- Council of Alexandria
  - Around 250 B.C., the original Hebrew language of the Old Testament was translated into Greek.
  - Done by a group of Jewish scholars in and around Alexandria, in Egypt.
  - SEPTUAGINT : (Latin: *septuaginta*) : 70
  - In making the translations, the scholars added other well-known books not originally written in Hebrew.
  - 1 and 2 Macabees, Tobit, Judith, Sirach, Wisdom & Baruch and some additional parts of Daniel & Esther.
    - Not accepted by the Council of Jamnia
    - Reasons:
      - Baruch: not written in Palestine;
      - Sirach & 1 Mac: written after 400B.C
      - Tobit & parts of Daniel & Ester: In Aramaic written outside Palestine;
      - Judith: Aramaic

- Wisdom: Greek
- 2 Mac: written after 400B.C & in Greek
- The Catholic Church accepted all the books of the Septuagint as canon.
  - Five Writings in the Catholic Bible
    - Baruch 6: Letter of Jeremiah
    - Daniel 3:31-100: Song of the 3 Men and Prayer of Azariah
    - Daniel 13: Susanna
    - Daniel 14: Bel and The Dragon
    - Esther (Greek): Sections added to Esther

#### IV. Catholic Bible (46 Books)

- a. New American Bible
- b. Jerusalem Bible
- c. Christian Community Bible
- d. Revised Standard Version (RSV)
- e. New Revised Standard Version (NRSV)
  - Nihil Obstat: “nothing opposes”
  - Imprimatur: “can be printed”

#### V. Ecumenical Bible (51 Books)

- a. Good News Bible – Today’s English Version
- b. Its Filipino Version

#### VI. Protestant Bible (39 Books)

- a. King James Version
- b. New International Version
- c. Gideon Bible

## **Session 2: The Conduct of the Liturgical Bible Study**

- I. Benefits of Bible Sharing (what struck you)
  - Developed appetite for God's Word
  - Deepened relationships in group and communities
  - Powerful insights on the word
  - Rich and depth sharing
  - Complemented formation programs – dioceses, parishes, schools, etc...
  
- II. However, there are these concerns:
  - People remember more of the life's stories of individuals than the Bible text or teachings
  - Reflection and sharing veer away from the text or were taken out of context
  - Sharing became monotonous and boring especially if people are in the group together for many years
  - No new sharing as sharing are recycled
  - No central message to bring home
  
- III. The LBS and Its Features
  - It is a group study with a facilitator
  - Not scholarly, however the study is serious enough
  - Structured
  - Accurate
  - Provides a central message that one can take home
  - Transformative because it provides for contextualization
  - Catechetical
  - Eucharistic

#### IV. LBS General Method

LBS is more of “paghihimay” and a little of “pagsasaliksik”

- Saliksik (Diachronic) Method
  - Studies origin, composition & evolution to present state
  - Example: Historical-critical method
  - In depth analysis: who wrote, when written, objectives for the writings, whom it was intended;
  - *Inuusisa, sinasaliksik, sinisiyasat*
- Himayin (Synchronic) Method
  - Studies text as it is and as it stands;
  - *Himayin* – going into the details
  - Camel chewing food 40 X
  - Extraction of vitamins & nutrients
  - Flavor

#### V. LBS Procedure

- Question and answer format
- Questions and answers are drawn from Biblical text
- Creativity and imagination also used
- Attention to details
- Basic: Who, when, where, what and how?

#### VI. LBS Structure

*Note: The facilitator or leader opens the Bible Study by reminding the members that today's texts will be taken from the readings of the coming Sunday. Giving the scriptural references of the texts will follow this. It will be much easier to let the members find all the texts and mark it on their own bible with a fluorescent (luminous) pen before proceeding further.*

- i. Opening Prayer
- ii. Bible Study Proper
  - a. Gospel

- Reading of the Text. Ask somebody to read the text

*Intro: A reading from the Holy Gospel according to the book/ gospel, chapter,*



verses

*Extro: The Word of the Lord*

- Exploration of the Text. The facilitator encourages the group to explore the text by asking questions based on the text. Together they will look for answers from the text that will shed light and understanding on the reading.
- Summary of the text. After exploring the text, the group will make a summary of the reading.

b. First Reading

- Reading of the Text
- Exploration of the Text
- Summary of the text

c. Second Reading

- Reading of the Text
- Exploration of the Text
- Summary of the text

d. One Thread

The group formulates a 'one-thread' message using the summaries of the readings. The 'one-thread' message expresses the unity of the three readings. The readings used in masses (whether 3 readings on Sundays or 2 readings on weekdays) from one theme or message.

e. Actualization/ Application

The biblical text has now become for us the "Word of God" and 'source of spiritual life'. The group will discuss how the message of the text is seen as a reality today.

- Actualizing the message of the biblical text within the community of believers, the Church
- Applying the message of the biblical text in one's personal lives

f. Closing Prayer/ Song

## **WORKSHOP 1: Actual Liturgical Bible Study**

The objective of this workshop is for them to have an actual experience of the Liturgical Bible Study

*Note: The readings to be used should be the upcoming Sunday Readings.*

## **WORKSHOP 2: LBS by group of three**

Instructions:

1. Have a grouping of threes.
2. Ask them to assign a facilitator on each of the readings (i.e. Gospel, First Reading and Second Reading)
3. The facilitator who was assigned to the:
  - a. Gospel will also facilitate the making of the “hibla”, the application question and sharing
  - b. First Reading will be the one to ask them of the connection of the Gospel and First Reading.
  - c. Second Reading will be the one to ask them of the connection of the Gospel, the First Reading and Second Reading.

*Note: The readings to be used should be the next Sunday Readings.*

PROCESSING QUESTIONS:

1. What worked well?
2. What are the difficulties?

**Session 3: Attitudes of An LBS Facilitator**

- I. How to be an effective LBS Facilitator
  - a. The right attitude is more important than the skills on how to conduct LBS.
    - i. Faith in the LBS method
    - ii. Hope in God's providence
    - iii. Love for God's Word
  - b. Skills can be quickly learned if one has the right attitude.
- II. Steps:
  - a. Prepare Well
    - i. Pray before, during, after an LBS Session.
    - ii. Study the readings in advance.
    - iii. Research for anything that is not clear or you want to understand in greater detail.
    - iv. Prepare the venue and other materials.
    - v. Keep an information database of attendees.
  - b. Be Friendly
    - i. Establish a friendly atmosphere
      - 1. Welcome the participants.
      - 2. Smile.
      - 3. Get interested about them
      - 4. Attend to anything they might need.
      - 5. Adjust to the profile of your audience.
      - 6. Be courteous. Use "Thank You" and "Please" often.
  - c. Begin Right
    - i. Opening Prayer
    - ii. Introduce self.
    - iii. Optional: Icebreaker activity
    - iv. Explain what LBS is about, especially if there are new attendees.

### III. Reminders

- a. Give Bible Texts
  - i. Check if everyone has a bible.
  - ii. Give the text guide for the 3 readings: Gospel, First Reading, Second Reading
  - iii. Help the participants locate the readings.
  - iv. Ask for 3 volunteers to read aloud the readings
- b. Be open to the leading of the Spirit. Answers may be different for each session.
- c. Should they ask you questions, be humble to admit when you do not know the answer.
- d. When the answer is already outside the bible text, politely bring back the discussion to the text.
- e. Don'ts
  - i. Do not say "wrong".
  - ii. Do not speak like you know it all.
  - iii. Do not embarrass anyone in public.
  - iv. Do not show any nervousness or lack of confidence... neither be over-confident.
  - v. Do not dominate the talking and answering.

### IV. Closing Exhortation

- a. 2 Timothy 3: 16 – 17 "All scripture is inspired by God and is useful for teaching, , for refutation, for correction, and for training in righteousness, so that one who belongs to God may be competent, equipped for every good work."
- b. Hebrews 4:12 "Indeed, the Word of God is living and effective, sharper than any two-edged sword, penetrating even between soul and spirit, joints and marrow, and able to discern reflections and thoughts of the heart

## **Building, Inspiring, and Forming a Killer Team**

### **Rationale**

As servants, we are entrusted by God to take care of his people. Even though we are young, we are given by God a privilege to lead His people. It is therefore important that we lead them well and lead them to the right place. There is also a challenge to lead young people these days, so all the servants of God's vineyard must learn the skill of motivating and leading their members well.

### **Objectives**

At the end of the session the participants will be able to:

1. Understand the privilege given to us by God to lead
2. Know the steps in forming a team
3. Know the skills in motivating and inspiring his/her team

### **Methodology**

|                |                  |
|----------------|------------------|
| 00:00 to 01:00 | Workshop         |
| 01:00 to 01:30 | Group Discussion |

### **Expanded Outline**

#### **I. Introduction**

Each of your members has felt God's presence and love in their lives. Be confident in that. Like us, it is God's love which moves them to work and serve, more often to the point of giving up their own comforts, wants and needs.

It is at this point where we should start. We are all servants. We are doing this for the love of our Lord. No one from your team or membership is indebted in any way to you or to anyone from your core group. The reason why they are serving is because they have felt God's real presence and wanted to share it.

## **II. Called to be Servants**

You are at a position where you have an authority to guide your members in their lives (family lives, love life, academics, etc.) and their service. You are called to mobilize them to an event or to a project, which you deem necessary. In the course of your work, you will eventually set up teams to efficiently carry out the work at hand. Be confident in where God has placed you. Take your place. Lead.

It is important for you as a servant to:

### **a) Pray**

Think on the premise that your core group will do only half of what you do.

(As their servant leader you should be the most prayerful in the group. So if you pray only twice a week, be afraid because most likely your core group will only be praying once a week.)

### **b) Work**

As their servant leader, you should be the most diligent in accomplishing tasks, the most friendly in your area, the most accommodating when it comes to requests, etc. You do not need to know everything. You will learn in the process. Your members are inspired with your examples so be ready to do things you wouldn't otherwise want to do. Do not be afraid to make mistakes. God will direct you every step of the way.

### **c) Love**

*Faith, hope and love... and the greatest of these is love (1 Cor 13:13)*

We are in the business of loving. We do not operate as a corporation; we do not measure a person's service or his heart for the service by the tasks at hand. We are not strict to enforce rules we know are rigid. We give room for love and for it to grow. Your actions, the way you do things, speak of your intentions and what is in your heart. So be sure to show love and not mere obedience.

## **III. Building and Forming Your Killer Team**

Work on the premise that we do not know everything. We do not choose based on specific skills; we choose based on a person's heart. It is better to have one inspired person than to have ten diligent people who are not inspired.

### **Your killer team checklist:**

1. Do not be afraid to get people who are better than you. We do not know everything. It is necessary that we get people who are good in specific fields. Do not hinder them from shining.
2. Form a complementing group. People who have mixed interests and specialties but who can help out and complement each other in a project. (Example, a person good with marketing, an organizer, a diligent secretariat, an amiable person to follow-up, etc.)
3. Be guarded in choosing based on your own preferences. Form a wide perspective in addressing all the members of your group. (Example: Get a person good in basketball to address all the sports needs and interests of your group.)

### **IV. Empowering Your Team**

- Be confident in your team.
- Do not do everything. Empower them by entrusting them to do things and show God's love through their work. You can start with little things to prepare them and help them along the way. You can delegate a huge task after they have grown in conviction in what they do.
- Honor in public, correct in private.
- Be stingy with criticism, be lavish in praises.

### **V. Keeping Your Team Inspired**

- Your core group meetings should be inspiring. (Meetings start with a short talk and/or sharing on what God has been saying to them before starting with the more technical issues. Take note that your team is there because they are inspired.)
- Make your team feel your genuine interest in them. Constantly ask how they are, be more relational than functional.
- Work, pray, and serve hard.
- Your team will be inspired by what they see in you. So constantly pray for guidance that you may do what the Lord calls you to do, obey what He is asking you to do and go out of your way to serve your members.

*Jesus said, ... whoever wants to go first should come last...*

## **VI. Conclusion**

Just as the Father has loved you, love. As He has served you in your life, serve. As He has empowered you, empower. As He has inspired you, inspire. That is how we are called - to share God's goodness in our lives. Allow yourselves to be conquered, leave room for God always.

### **Group discussion:**

- What are your challenges in leading a team?
- Give concrete ways on how you can motivate your team now.



# MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

## Core Circle

### Chapter Servants Training Manual



## Visionary Leadership

### Rationale

MFC Youth servants should have a vision in leading their own chapter. They must set a goal so that their members will continuously be inspired and aim for that vision.

### Participants

- MFC Youth Chapter Servants
- MFC Youth Chapter Coordinators

### Objectives

At the end of the session, the participants will be able to:

- Know the process and considerations in discerning for a vision
- Be able to set a vision for their respective chapter

### Methodology

|                |          |
|----------------|----------|
| 00:00 to 01:00 | Workshop |
| 01:00 to 01:15 | Activity |

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction

Probably, the most important task facing a servant leader is to develop an understanding of where the organization needs to be at some point. Without a future vision, organizations are destined to live in the past, and eventually die. “Where there is no vision, the people perish” Proverbs 29:18. For the Christian organization, such vision must come from God.

#### II. Visionary leadership: Leaders that see

As MFC Youth Chapter servants we must have vision. Vision is “seeing” where we are supposed to go. Vision is seeing, almost as if it were a photograph, where our groups will be a year from now, or five years from now, or fifty – one hundred years from now. If a leader has vision, then he can

chart some sort of path – a direction to take in order to get to the destination – to realize his vision.

In this workshop, we hope to begin to learn what it's like to be visionary servants.



### III. Process of Developing a Vision

This process will take time. Maybe some months to work through fully so don't feel you need to rush! It can either be used by the leader alone or preferably with a small leadership group, which may be the formal leadership group of the church or may be a selected group of people with appropriate skills and gifts. At the end of this process, you should understand what you believe God is calling your church or organization to do and to be.

1. Preparatory Prayer – Tuning in to the Lord. Praying for what God wants for your chapter.
2. Building Blocks – These are the ways where God speak to us. These are the elements where our vision will be formed.
  - The past or history – The vision of the chapter can be an answer to a past situation of the chapter.
  - Experience – Based from our experience, what is the best thing to do right now? How about 6 months after? 1 year after?
  - Prophecy through worship and prayer – Sometimes, God speaks directly through His people. Spend time speaking to members who regularly pray.
  - The community it serves – what are the needs of the people in the community? The vision can also be an answer to that need.
3. Prayer – After forming the vision from the 4 elements above, spend more time in prayer to purify it.
4. Drafting the Vision – The first thing in making a vision into a reality is to write it. It should be short but clearly worded. Also, the vision should be a “big idea.” Details will be the action plan/s for the vision.

In drafting the vision, ask these following questions:

- Is it in line with scriptural teaching? Does the vision that you have received lead to God being glorified, and His church taking a servant role in meeting the needs of His people?
- Is there a consensus in the pictures, Scriptures and words of knowledge received? Spend some time going back and identify whether any elements point an opposite

direction. (They may point a different direction if they are related to meeting a specific need, rather than setting God's agenda for His church.)

- Do you, and others who are with you in the process, feel at peace with the vision in prayer? This does not mean that you feel comfortable about achieving it or merely feeling that it may be "right"!
- Does this fit with where God is already moving? It may not if this is a new wave of God's Spirit at work, but in many cases, it may be a continuation of God's prompting in the wider church. When shared with other mature Christians in the church, does their prayer confirm it?

5. Sharing the Vision — Once you agree, it is time to share and develop the vision with the wider community of faith. Encourage people to think, reflect and pray through the vision. It may be necessary to change it over time as the whole community comes to "own" the vision for itself.

**Here are indicators if your members have adopted the vision for themselves:**

- a. They understand it. You can hear them explaining it to others, simply and correctly.
- b. They share it. When talking about it, they use "we" rather than "the vicar/pastor/leader".
- c. They are moving towards it. Their suggestions and activities are consistent with the vision, rather than pointing in a different direction.

6. Action – A vision that does not lead to some kind of action is unlikely to be of much help to the church or to God! However, turning a vision into reality can be extremely difficult. As a first step, spend more time with a small leadership group and begin to explore ways that could make the vision a reality.



#### IV. Workshop

1. Ask the participants to sit with their co-Chapter Servants. If the group is too small, ask them to group by chapter. Give each person a copy of the handout.
2. Lead the participants into prayer. As the reflection song is sung, the group is asked to reflect on the 4 building blocks in creating a vision.
3. After some time, each member of the group should write down what they feel God is

calling the chapter to do. Everyone should write something that they would share to the group.

4. After each person has shared his/her vision, spend some more time in prayer, asking the Lord to confirm which elements of your discussions are His, and which are human desires. Ask them to discuss openly, and move on if you have an agreement, otherwise repeat step 2. (Use the questions above to check the visions).
5. Ask them to draft the vision that is to be shared to the rest of their members the next time they meet them.
6. End with a closing rally song while praying for the vision.

# MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

## Core Circle

### Chapter Servants Training Manual



## Strategic Planning

### Rationale

MFC Youth servants should have a plan in leading their own chapter. This workshop will make the participants have strategies.

### Participants

- MFC Youth Chapter Servants
- MFC Youth Chapter Couple Coordinators

### Objectives

At the end of the session, the participants will be able to:

- Know the strategies in planning for the areas
- Be able to reach a goal by having an action plan

### Methodology

|                |          |
|----------------|----------|
| 00:00 to 00:30 | Workshop |
| 00:30 to 00:45 | Activity |

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction: Groups that get nowhere

The problem of many organizations is that their leaders lack vision. Many leaders are reactive – making decisions and setting directions based on what is popular or just on what other leaders are doing. It is like trying to get home by following the cars in front of you. There may be a one in a million chance you might find your way home, if you happen to be following your neighbor's car, but more probably, you will spend your whole life running in circles.

This is the reason why many members of organizations such as these are not motivated and worse, are critical. In the same way that people in a car that's going in circles and never gets to its destination are irritable, so do members in an organization become difficult and irritable when its leaders have no idea what the destination is.

## **II. Our present situations**

*Note: This part of the workshop aims to identify the situation / level of growth of an area. It will help the servants see how close or how far they are from their goals.*

### **A. Stakeholders Demands (15 Minutes)**

#### **a. List All Stakeholders.**

List down all the different people/ groups that for one reason or the other have set expectations / something at stake (“stakeholders”) from MFC Youth in your areas. (e.g. Members, Core group, schools and campuses, parents, MFC Couple Coordinators etc.)

#### **b. Who expects from whom?**

Determine from whom each stakeholder’s demands are directed to. *(Each stakeholder generally expects from only one other stakeholder. Although there may be a few exceptions, for the purposes of the workshop and its need for “focus”, this should always be the case. Choose the group from which the stakeholder in question “expects the most” from).*

#### **c. List down the demands / expectations of each stakeholder**

For example, “What are my demands as a parent, from MFC Youth Couple Coordinators?” “What are the demands of the Campus’ administration from the campus based servants?” “What are the demands of MFC Kids from MFC Youth in your areas?”

### **B. Evaluation: (Show Sample 1)**

How well do we address the demands?

- i. **Collate all the demands of the Area stakeholders**
- ii. **On a scale of 1-5, rate your Area**

How well are you able to address these expectations?

(5 being the highest and 1 the lowest)

**SAMPLE 1**  
**AREA EVALUATION**



| STAKEHOLDERS / DEMANDS                                    | POINTS                                         |          |          |   |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|---|----------|
|                                                           | 1                                              | 2        | 3        | 4 | 5        |
| <b><u>Members to Household</u></b>                        |                                                |          |          |   |          |
| <b><u>1. I demand to have fun</u></b>                     |                                                |          |          |   | *        |
| <b><u>2. I demand to be inspired and nourished</u></b>    |                                                | *        |          |   |          |
| <b><u>3. I expect to be informed about activities</u></b> |                                                | *        |          |   |          |
| <b><u>4. I expect meetings to start on time</u></b>       | *                                              |          |          |   |          |
| <b><u>5. I expect to have a household</u></b>             |                                                |          |          |   |          |
|                                                           |                                                |          |          |   |          |
| <b><u>Household to Chapter Servants</u></b>               |                                                |          |          |   |          |
| <b><u>1. I expect to be trained</u></b>                   |                                                | *        |          |   |          |
| <b><u>2. I expect to be inspired</u></b>                  |                                                |          | *        |   |          |
| <b><u>3. I expect to be utilized</u></b>                  |                                                |          | *        |   |          |
| <b><u>4. I expect to have a chapter assembly</u></b>      |                                                | *        |          |   |          |
| <b><u>Scores</u></b>                                      | <b>1</b>                                       | <b>8</b> | <b>6</b> |   | <b>5</b> |
| <b>TOTAL</b> (This is how close we are to our goals)      | 20/40<br><br>(WE'RE HALF WAY TO OUR GOALS!!!!) |          |          |   |          |

**C. Draw your present situation (10 minutes)**

Draw a picture that symbolizes the situation of your area based on your evaluation.

**D. Reporting (20 minutes)**

Each group reports what they came up with during this portion of the workshop.

**(Note: This in effect, represents the growth rate / situation of your area).**



### III. Where do we want to go

*Note: This part of the workshop aims to help Servants to define and state their long term vision and goals for the year for their areas. This will help determine in turn the direction, strategies and activities of the areas.*

Now that we know more or less where our particular groups are, we need to be able to determine where it is we want to take our groups to. Where do we go from here? What are our long-term visions and short-term goals?

#### A. Vision statement / Goals for the year

##### Sample Vision statements:

*“Missionary Families of Christ: We are an evangelistic and missionary community committed to become families empowered by the Holy Spirit to renew the face of the earth.”*

##### i. Write down your personal vision statement for your area (5-7 minutes)

- a. It should state what you believe to be God’s plan for MFC Youth in your areas.
- b. You should be able to state your vision in one sentence.
- c. Although flowery words may be nice, your vision statement should describe what you genuinely believe will happen to MFC Youth in your areas.

##### ii. Write your short-term vision /goal for the year (5-7 minutes)

- a. What will MFC Youth in your areas look like at the end of the year?
- b. Again state it in one sentence.

#### B. List conditions that will tell you that you have reached your goal (15 minutes)

(e.g. “Our Area will increase in membership by 50%, we will involve more MFC Youth with MFC Kids service, and campus based”).

### IV. How do we get there? (Sample)

#### A. Sample vision

“Increase in membership and empowerment of more servant leaders”



**Strategies** (How can this vision be realized)

1. Establish Stability
2. Assure Continuity
3. Establish culture (FACE)

**Action Plan / Activities**

1. How can we achieve stability?
  - a. Manuals
  - b. Establish structure / Work closely with the other MFC Sections
2. How can we achieve continuity?
  - a. Assure continuity of servant leaders
  - b. Train servant leaders
3. How can we achieve “FACE?”
  - a. Crowd and Congregation activities
  - b. Strengthen Households
  - c. Pray harder

**B. Year Vision / Goal**

“To double in number”

**Strategies** (How can this vision be realized)

1. Encourage evangelization more
2. More Youth camps

**Action Plan / Activities**

1. How can we encourage evangelization more
  - a. E-project
  - b. FEC
2. How can we allow more youth camps to happen?
  - a. Empower the chapters more

## **V. Tips**

### **a. Pray for the Lord's guidance and Sprit**

### **b. Empowerment / Delegation**

- i. Assure accountability – Assign a “person in charge” and a team
- ii. Clarify goals
- iii. Identify resources
- iv. Determine a timetable / deadlines / activity date

### **c. As you plan an activity in detail**

Walk through the activity (as if you were actually there. What would you see first?  
Therefore, what needs to be prepared?

## **Together to Get There**

### **Objectives**

1. Identify the different misconceptions of a one-to-ones and be able to correct them
2. Appreciate the importance of a regular one-to-ones
3. Practice how to conduct a one-to-ones with their respective members

### **Methodology**

|           |                  |
|-----------|------------------|
| 0:00-0:15 | Opening Activity |
| 0:15-1:15 | Talk Proper      |
| 1:15-1:30 | Open Forum       |

### **Opening Activity: Round the Clock**

1. Group the participants divided equally in two (2) groups. Have Group 1 form a circle and Group 2 form a bigger circle around Group 1.
2. Make sure each member of Group 1 is facing a member from Group 2. They will be the pair in the game.
3. Each round will have two (2) parts:
  - a. For the first part, Group 1 will be the sharer and Group 2 will be the listener.
  - b. For the second part, Group 1 will be the listener and Group 2 will be the sharer.
4. On each round the facilitator will state a question which will be discussed by the pairs. On each part of the round, the sharer will be the one to answer the question while the listener listens to the sharer.
5. On each part, the listener will be given one (1) minute to share their answer to the listener.
6. After each round, Group 1 will take one step clockwise while Group 2 will take one step counter clockwise.
7. The activity will end after 5 rounds or when the pairs go back to the first pairs at start of the activity if time permits.

### Suggested Questions for the Speaker:

- Anong soundtrack ng buhay mo ngayon?
- Five years from now, sino ka na sa tingin mo?
- Kumusta ang SHOUT experience mo so far?

This activity is a reminder for us servant leaders on the importance of talking and listening. When we realize when to talk and when to listen, we are able to reach out and understand our members better.

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction

In the community setting, servant leaders are given the task and privilege to take care of their members, to be able to take time and listen to them and be there for them. In doing so, one particular practice that we do in the community is the one-to-ones.

One-to-ones is called as such because it stands for “someone is talking to someone” or “I am talking to you.” This is a very common practice in the community especially in YFL. As servant leaders in a journey of spiritual accompaniment with our members, it is important that we understand where they are in their respective journeys. Having an effective one-to-ones is a good tool in accompanying them in their spiritual journey.

#### II. Misconceptions About One-to-Ones

Most of us have experienced one-to-ones and we have had different experiences. If not all, many have had difficulty in inviting a member for a one-to-ones. What are the possible reasons of our members in refusing our invitation to talk?

- One-to-ones is done only during Youth Camp.
- One-to-ones happens only when there is a needs pastoral correction.
- One-to-ones is done only when a member is given a bigger task in the ministry.
- One-to-ones is done only for the servant leaders to learn about the bad habits and shameful past of their members.
- One-to-ones crosses the members' privacy when servant leaders discuss their conversation with other servant leaders due to a pastoral concern.
- One-to-ones can be conducted between mission partners (brother and sister).

Such misconceptions are sometimes the reasons why one-to-ones doesn't happen or doesn't end as they should – to build relationship with our members. As servant leaders, our goals are for our members to understand what we do during one-to-ones and make them feel safe to open up and allow us to accompany them in their spiritual journey.

### III. One-to-Ones: What It Really Is

It can definitely be a challenge for servant leaders to invite their members to one-to-ones especially if they have the wrong notion of it, but as servant leaders, we have to know what it really is, its value and beauty.

- One-to-ones is being Jesus to your members.

Jesus experiences are not reserved in big events like the WYC, Youthfest or the AYC. One-to-one's is the perfect opportunity to be Jesus to our members in the way we make time for them, stay with them, listen to their stories and give them sound advice based on the Bible, Church teachings and our community teachings.

- One-to-ones is building relationship with your members.

When we make time for them and reach out to them, we open doors of stronger bonds with them. Relationships are built over time. In allowing ourselves to be available for them in one-to-one's, we are laying down a good foundation where life-giving relationships can start.

- One-to-ones is loving and making your members feel loved.

They say, "love is effort." When we conduct one-to-one's with our members, we are actually loving them. We go out of ourselves and share parts of who we are to them. Aside from that, we are able to make them feel loved through the simple fact of dropping everything just to be with them when they need us the most.

- One-to-ones is journeying with your members towards heaven.

Just like how Jesus encountered the two disciples on the Road to Emmaus (Lk 24:13-35) and made them remember who He is, we are called to remind our members of our ultimate destiny as Christians and that is to strive for holiness, be one with God in Heaven one day and see Him face-to-face.

### IV. Towards Excellent One-to-Ones

Conducting one-to-ones is indeed important and helpful in our journey of spiritual accompaniment; thus, we need to prioritize it as much as we can. Here are **3 C's** to ensure that we conduct quality and life-giving one-to-one's with our members:



## 1. Consider the Basics

- One-to-ones is a pastoral tool, not a service tool for the household servants.
- One-to-ones should be done between two brothers or two sisters. Mission partners talk in what we call a “service meeting,” not one-to-one’s.
- Confidentiality must be ensured during one-to-ones; however, when a concern needs to be addressed, it is also important to make them understand that the conversation may be opened to other involved servant leaders.

## 2. Clear Your Agenda

- One-to-ones is a way for servant leaders to be able to get to know their members and understand how to accompany them in their spiritual journey.
- Household servants need not to be too assertive but be more of a guide and listener while giving possible options to his/her members.

## 3. Create Genuine Relationships

- Household servants should make sure that they have no other commitments before or after the one-to-ones that may distract them from giving their full attention to the person, they’re having one-to-ones with.
- Pay attention, recall and follow up on a previous one-to-one discussion.
- As much as possible, never cancel a one-to-one’s schedule.

## IV. Conclusion

One-to-ones is an important part of our task as servant leaders in accompanying our members in their spiritual journey. **It is one sure way to journey together to get there – nowhere else than Heaven.** We have, at one point in our lives, experienced a spirit-filled conversation with our own servant leaders that somehow made an impact on the persons we’ve become. May we be driven to do the same and pay it forward. By devoting our whole mind, heart, body and soul in conducting one-to-one’s, we are actually responding to MFC Youth’s mission order, “Make All Youth Know Christ.”

## **V. Activity: Plan Your One to Ones**

1. On a piece of paper, the participants are instructed to write the names of their lower household members in the space provided.
2. Below the names there are boxes with the following titles:
  - Box 1 – New in the Household (less than six months)
  - Box 2 – Have Shared in the Household Something that Bothered You
  - Box 3 – Those That Don't Share Much during Household
  - Box 4 – Don't Attend the Household Often
  - Box 5 – You Don't Know Much About Them
3. In each box, the participants are instructed to write down the names of those household members that suit what the title describes. One name may be written in more than one box, as long as they fit the description.
4. Based on the results, ask the participants to plan their one-to-ones. They will choose who they should talk to first and make a schedule.

**Note:** *The minimum frequency of one-to-ones is twice a year, but the household servant should be able to discern well to conduct it more than two times based on his/her members' needs.*

## **VI. Open Forum**

The audience is given 15 minutes to ask or clarify things about one-to-ones.



## VII. Handout

Area: \_\_\_\_\_

Chapter: \_\_\_\_\_

Name of Household Members:

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### MY ONE-TO-ONE'S SCHEDULE

**NAME OF MEMBER**

**ONE TO ONE DATE**

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*Note: After each one-to-one's, it is at the Servant Leader's prerogative how often will they be having a one to ones with a particular member.*



# MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

## Core Circle

### Chapter Servants Training Manual



## Leading a Youth Assembly

### Rationale

This workshop teaches the new MFC Youth Chapter Servants in handling and preparing for a chapter assembly – how to make it nourishing and Christ-centered.

### Participants

- MFC Youth Chapter Servants
- MFC Youth Chapter Couple Coordinators

### Objectives

At the end of the session, the participants will be able to:

- Understand why a chapter assembly is important
- Know how to conduct a chapter assembly
- Learn how to discern and choose a chapter assembly topic
- Learn how to make their own chapter assembly topic

### Methodology

0:00-0:45 Workshop

0:45-1:15 Activity

### Expanded Outline

#### I. Introduction

Chapter assemblies are part of the culture of MFC Youth, the youth section of the Missionary Families of Christ. MFC Youth realized the need for chapter assemblies as a part of a culture that is to be a lifestyle among its members. It aims to establish a culture of prayer as a community with the elements of fun, acceptance, excellence, and Christ-centeredness.

This guide aims to orient the Chapter Servants about the basics of chapter assemblies. It also intends to give the chapters the adequate materials and documents for a paralleled spiritual growth through the tracks, checklists, etc. that are especially designed for MFC Youth.



## **II. What is a Chapter Assembly?**

A chapter assembly is a meeting of MFC Youth members held once a month preferably during Saturdays in the premises of their parishes. It is a time to come together to worship the Lord, hear His words and share the goodness and blessings He has given the group. It is an affirmation to everyone that truly God works not only in their individual lives but also in the lives of other members within their chapter.

Chapter assemblies are also used as a venue to respond to the spiritual needs and different concerns of the members. Therefore, each chapter should strategically select the time and day when they will conduct the chapter assembly to ensure that the members will be able to attend and participate in it. We should then realize that a chapter assembly should be:

- Fun - It should be fun and be a place where people can enjoy and build friendships.
- Accepting - It should make everyone feel accepted and belonged.
- Christ-Centered - It should be nourishing and it should leave the members encouraged and refreshed of God's love for them. It should be for Christ, about Christ and be all because of Christ.
- Excellent - It should be excellent and well-prepared. Its excellence should inspire people to look forward to the next chapter assembly, and above everything else, to honor God.

## Suggested Schedule for a Chapter Assembly:



|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 20 minutes | Gathering/ Fellowship/ Registration/ Updating                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 10 minutes | Music Ministry teaches a new song.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 15 minutes | Prayer Meeting Leader acknowledges those attending the prayer meeting for the first time (They may be asked to introduce themselves).                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 15 minutes | Worship – A time to sing songs, pray and listen to the word of the Lord. (After the worship, once people are seated, the prayer meeting leader can first summarize the prophecies, and what he heard from the Lord during the worship to help set the tone for the meeting).                                                                        |
| 20 minutes | Sharings – People share about the blessings they have received, victories in their lives and lessons they have learned for the past week. Songs may be sung from time to time to avoid the monotony of sharers. (It is important that the music ministry listens to the sharings for them to play songs which are appropriate for a specific time.) |
| 25 minutes | Talk - The talk given is based on the topic that the Chapter Servants and Chapter Couple Coordinators have chosen for that specific month from the Chapter Assembly Track.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 15 minutes | Summary/ Closing Announcements/ Prayer/ Song                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

*Note: Ice Breaker or short games can also be included in the schedule. Schedule is flexible as to what topic is to be given on such a certain Chapter Assembly.*

### III. Things to Remember

- Chapter Assemblies should be held consistently once a month to promote a culture of prayer and sharing among MFC Youth members.
- The planning and implementation of a chapter assembly will always be done by the Chapter Servants along with the guide of their Chapter Couple Coordinators and the overseeing of their Area Servants.
- The Chapter Servants have the freedom to choose which topic is to be discussed for a particular month either from the Chapter Assembly Track or from their own discerned topic



choices, highly regarding the needs of the members.

- Chapter Servants can invite Full-Time Workers, Heart Crusaders and MFC Youth Servants from other areas to give the talk.
- Chapter Servants and Household Servants should inform their members about an upcoming Chapter Assembly, at least one week before the event, so as to give everyone ample time to fix their schedules.

#### **IV. Practical Tips to Consider**

- The Service Team should arrive at the venue at least an hour before the registration time for members so that they can prepare the venue efficiently and excellently. The Service Team consists of the following: Prayer Meeting Leader (brother), Secretariat and Welcoming Committee, Logistics Committee, Music Ministry, Speaker, Game Masters (optional).
- Choose a well-lit and well-ventilated venue that would be conducive for the learning of all the members. Make it comfortable for the attendees.
- Designing the whole venue with tarps, taffetas, colored cloth to convey the theme of your assembly would be very much commendable (although not required).
- The best seating arrangement for a Chapter Assembly is the U-Shape arrangement. This is for the attendees to see the speaker and will be able to participate well.
- The Music Ministry should always sit in front so as not to distract the other attendees of the Chapter Assembly during times when they have to go on stage and play their instruments especially during the session (ex. For Reflection Song of the Session).
- Always have a good sound system during Chapter Assemblies. Be at the venue early to check the microphone, amplifiers, etc.
- Visuals for Song Lyrics, Talk Points, etc. (with the use of the laptop and projector) would be very much helpful in making the assembly more dynamic.

#### **V. Chapter Assembly Checklist**

##### **a. Prayer Meeting Leader**

- i. Should be chosen by the Chapter Servant at least one week before the scheduled prayer meeting to give him ample time to pray and prepare.
- ii. Must have undergone a “How to Lead a Youth Assembly” workshop.
- iii. Must be a brother.



b. Worship Leader

- i. Should be chosen by the Chapter Servant at least 1 week before the scheduled prayer meeting to give him ample time to pray and prepare
- ii. Must know how to lead worship
- iii. Must have undergone a “Worship Workshop”
- iv. Must always coordinate with the Music Ministry

c. Music Ministry

- i. Must always coordinate with the Prayer Meeting Leader and the Worship Leader before the scheduled prayer meeting
- ii. Makes sure songs are taught before the worship starts. Makes sure members know basic songs.
- iii. Makes sure songbooks and visual aids for the lyrics are available.
- iv. Must practice well before the Chapter Assembly

d. Sharers

- i. There should always be at least 2 pre-selected sharers just in case there are no impromptu sharers during the Big Group Sharing.
- ii. They must always be briefed by the Prayer Meeting Leader before the scheduled prayer meeting. Sharing should always be Audible, Brief and Christ-centered.
- iii. Household Servants of the Chapter should encourage their members to share or give suggestions for sharers.

e. Topic / Teaching

- i. The Chapter Servant has the freedom to choose which topic is to be discussed for a particular month as long as each topic in the Chapter Assembly Track is tackled all throughout one MFC Youth year.
- ii. The Household Servants of the Chapter should take an active part during the selection process.
- iii. Dynamic activities or games related to the topic can be given before the talk proper to make it more relevant and fun for all the members.

f. Creative Elements

- i. IDs, registration and physical arrangement
- ii. Food and Drinks
- iii. Honoring or Awarding. (eg. Most complete household, early bird, birthdays, etc.).

- iv. Music Ministry
- v. Presentations - comedy skits, games, dance, song numbers, etc.  
(Avoid irrelevant presentations). Use such only to enhance the theme.
- vi. Videos and Teasers regarding previous and future YFL events

*\*Note: Creative elements included in chapter assemblies such as presentations and the like should be coordinated with MFC Youth LIT. Those mentioned above are just suggested activities.*

- g. Promotions
  - i. Text brigade and phone brigade
  - ii. Creative flyers, posters, memos, etc.
  - iii. Letter of consent to parents (optional)
  - iv. Personal Invitation to Members (house-to-house)
  - v. Social media and Website promotions

## **VI. Workshop**

1. Divide the body into two groups.
2. The first group will be the Service Team. The second group will be the Assembly attendees.
3. The first group should assign a Prayer Meeting Leader, Secretariat or Welcoming Committee, Logistics Committee (seating arrangement, décor, etc.), Speaker for the Chapter Assembly, Music Ministry, and Game Master.
4. The mock chapter assembly is done.
5. Afterwards, the 2nd group will comment on what the first group did well and those that they forgot to implement according to the talk given. Allow the first group also to share, their feedback regarding their attendees, what they observed to be the needs of the attendees, and what they believed to be their strengths and areas of improvement.

## **VII. Conclusion**

Chapter Assemblies are God's instruments for us to be nourished. During chapter assemblies, we grow more as a family in our chapters. We grow inspired from the stories of our dear brothers and sisters in community and above all, we grow more in a loving relationship with our Lord. Let us give them our best and let us put much value in coming up with nourishing and excellent chapter assemblies for our members and for the greater glory of our God.

## **Relating with Couple Coordinator**

### **Rationale**

In our youth ministry, couple coordinators and youth servants must work together to pastor and nurture the youth, under their care, that God had entrusted to them. They have different yet complimentary roles that they must perform to bring the youth, under their care, closer to God. Thus, in our youth ministry it is essential for couple coordinators and youth servants to build up, learn from and understand one another.

### **Objectives**

At the end of this workshop, the participants will be able to:

- Understand the typical mind-set and outlook of couple coordinators
- Be more open and relate better with his/her couple coordinators

### **Methodology**

|             |                |
|-------------|----------------|
| 00:00-00:05 | Opening prayer |
| 00:05-00:20 | Activity       |
| 00:20-00:55 | Talk Proper    |
| 00:55-01:00 | Closing Prayer |

### **Activity**

First, divide the participants into groups of Ten (10). Then, ask each group to portray or describe their couple coordinators through a Gag presentation. After each of the group has presented, the speaker may begin his talk and may use the different Gag presentations as examples.

### **Expanded Outline**

#### **I. Introduction**

It's always fun to laugh at our couple coordinators, because there are really times that they are funny; and then there are those times when they can be so annoying and frustrating, or even worse, bossy, unreasonable and dreadful. These are the times when we don't want to do anything with them and we see them as such a pain. The reason for this is that we never really understood where they

are coming from and that we never really thought of their perspective on things.

1. How we typically see our Couple Coordinators

(the speaker must cite examples to illustrate these better to the participants).

**Our couple coordinators can have these good qualities:**

- Caring
- Understanding
- Fun to be with
- Approachable
- Patient
- Hard-working
- Committed
- Loving

**Then again, our couple coordinators can have these negative attitudes:**

- Bossy
- Intimidating
- Unreasonable
- Perfectionist
- Strict or Disciplinarian
- Preachy
- Apathetic or Indifferent
- Lazy
- Do it all

Indeed, we see our couple coordinators as second parents, thoughtful, caring and generous. We see them as trustworthy confidantes to our love life, school concerns and family problems. Yet, most of the time, we focus on the negative relationship with them. We never forgive them for reprimanding us when we made mistakes in the past. We get frustrated with them often for either being indifferent or bossy but we never took the risk of telling them because we are not confident in our relationship with them. We never gave them a chance.

2. How our Couple Coordinators see us

We need to understand where our couple coordinators are coming from. We need to be aware of their reasons why they are the way they are with us sometimes; and a big part of it has to do



with the way they perceive us.



Earlier, through your Gag presentations, we saw how we see our couple coordinators. Now, this is how they see us, sometimes:

- a. Unreliable – We do not always perform tasks based on the expectations of adults.
  - We organize venues and logistics but fail to plan and deliver the details (e.g. microphones for PA systems, etc.) which they have to take-on, being our couple coordinators.
  - We rarely come on time. Time does not seem to be an important element to us. However, time is very precious to them because they still need to balance their time with work and family, aside from their service.
- b. Indecisive – Sometimes we want one thing, the next time we decide we want the opposite.
  - We may have agreed on something, but suddenly we changed our mind at the last minute. We may be fickle-minded; but once we already have a commitment, we have to do it.
  - We may have planned to attend an activity but later on decided not to go even when there are expectations from us as youth servants.
- c. Hard to communicate with – We cannot communicate as well; whereas adults tend to be clear about what they want to say.
  - We cannot express our thoughts and feelings and thus, we sometimes simply decide to keep our thoughts to ourselves. (e.g. We use youth jargons like “wala lang, super, grabe” etc.)
  - Our age gap and the technology gap between us and them do not help either.
  - Short-term in thinking – We do not think of tomorrow, we just think of today. We do not think of future plans, but just the present tasks that need to be done, in the here and now.
  - We know that our couple coordinators must trust and believe in us but sometimes we are to blame as well. If we do not want them to be a pain to us, then we should prove to them that they can really trust us and not be unreliable, indecisive or short-term in thinking.

### 3. Understanding our Couple Coordinators better

For our relationship with our couple coordinators to become better, we need to understand first where they are coming from.

- a. Our couple coordinators do not want to be treated inappropriately.
  - They are not just there to take us to and fetch us at the venues.
  - They are not just there to look out for us and provide what we need.

- They are not just there to cook our food during youth camps and other activities.
- They are not just there to fund our activities.

b. Our couple coordinators have needs of their own and they have so many other things on their minds besides taking care of us.

- They have their own families to take care of. They are also parents themselves and they also have their own children to look after.
- They have their jobs and businesses to maintain; and they have to deal with all the stress and frustrations that comes these.
- They have their own personal problems to think about besides ours.

c. Our couple coordinators always mean well. They always want what is best for us in everything they do.

- They mean well even during times when we do not see eye to eyes on things.
- They mean well even during times that they reprimand us.

#### 4. Attitudes to take when relating with our Couple Coordinators

a. Treat them with the respect that they deserve.

- It is God who called them to take care of and guide us in order for us to become closer to Him. The reason why they became couple coordinators is because they love God as much as we do.
- In our community, they serve as our second parents. We must obey them just as how we obey our own parents because they love us like their own children.

b. Listen to their wisdom.

- We must learn from them because they have a lot to teach us. They have the breadth of their experience behind them. They have already gone through the things we are only experiencing now or are about to. Their experiences over the years have made them wise.
- In planning for our activities, we cannot help but be very idealistic yet our Couple Coordinators always look after the practical side of things because they don't want us to fail.



- c. Appreciate them.
  - They are not perfect but they do mean well and they do take care of us. We must believe that without them, it would be very difficult for us to accomplish anything.
- d. Be open to them.
  - Confide in them. We must get personal with them. We must come to a point when we can already trust them with all our fears, hopes and aspirations.
  - Communicate with them regularly. We must make them part of our plans about our area. They are our partners in mission and we must help one another out.
  - Be open to their correction. We must remember that they only want to make us better persons.

## **II. Conclusion**

Our couple coordinators may not be perfect but they are certainly God's gift to us. They serve as our guides, role models and partners in pastoring and nurturing the youth that God has entrusted to our care. We simply need to trust in God's wisdom.